

The Youth Leadership Development Programme

Change Project Proposal Template

Dear Participant,

Well Done on Making it to the Community Change Project/Sustainability Pathway!

See below the template to ensure you and your team of 5 persons create a winning proposal. If you follow the directions in the guide and leverage your key learnings from the Virtual training, you and your team stand a chance to win the available Small or Large Subgrants to execute change projects across communities in Nigeria. Please read the following instructions carefully:

- In each section below, you are given a brief description of your team's expectations. Kindly give **brief & clear** descriptions of your intended change project
- In Sections Two through Seven, please give high-level activities to help you achieve your desired project goal.
- Make sure to include a budget for all the resources you need for your project. Please be advised that you can win up to N400,000 based on the strength of your ideas/implementation plan. Please work within these limits, giving some justification for every line item. (There are two categories of microgrants: Large Grants: N400,000 and small grants: N200,000)
- To submit your change project proposal, Kindly upload it [here](#). Applications submitted after the stated deadline will not be considered.
- Please name your proposal using this naming convention “**Team Name>>Name of School>>Date (eg. TeamImpact>>UniversityofLagos>>26062024)**”
- All Change Project Proposals should be written according to this template, using the following guidelines.
 - **Section 1: Introduction**
 - **Section 2: Change Project Scope Definition**
 - **Section 3: Defining Project Stakeholders**
 - **Section 4: Risk Assessment**
 - **Section 5: Project Schedule**
 - **Section 6: Budget**
 - **Section 7: Project Evaluation**

We are excited for you and look forward to sharing your impact stories!

The Youth Leadership Development Programme Team

Section One: Team Introduction

Team Name <i>Hint: Please select a name that is reflective of your team's purpose E.g. Team Reading to Lead</i>	Team Abilities Beyond Disabilities
Names, Phone numbers, and Email Addresses of Team Members <i>(Please indicate the team lead and team deputy. We advise that a team's leadership is reflective of its gender and social inclusion composition)</i> <i>Please use this format:</i> <i>Kehinde Ayeni - ylp@leapafrica.org - 080 999 9999</i>	1. Obiokoye Chibueze Stella (Team Lead) - obiokoyechibueze@gmail.com - 08110445408 2. Victor Ikechukwu Nwafor (Team Deputy) - dixonsilverofficial@gmail.com – 09047921865 3. Mgbabor Ugochukwu Cyrina - Linamarcel288@gmail.com – 09122564908 4. Ekwueme Richard Ikenna - ekwuemeikennarich@gmail.com – 08157017809 5. Onyeka Ifeoma Vera - ifeomavera227@gmail.com – 09020773058 6. Ezeagwula Adaeze Confidence - pearladaeze16@gmail.com – 09136633486 7. Ituma Virtuous Ogochukwu - virtuousogochukwu@gmail.com - 08065043484
Thematic Area <i>Hint: Please note that your project must be focused on one or more of the following:</i> • <i>Social Inclusion for Marginalised Groups and Persons with Disabilities</i> • <i>Electoral Engagement and Democratic Participation</i> • <i>Public Transparency and Accountability</i> • <i>Policy and Advocacy</i> • <i>National Cohesion, Peace and Security</i> <i>Cross cutting priorities are innovation, technology, media and creative expression</i>	Social Inclusion for Marginalised Groups and Persons with Disabilities

Section Two: Change Project Scope Definition

Problem Analysis <i>(Please share background into the problem your project is trying to solve and the reason behind your choice)</i>	This project was inspired by my relationship with Sister Rebecca, a deaf woman in my church. Over time, I became one of the people who assisted her in communication and participation during church activities. Through my interactions with her, I began to understand the challenges she faces daily because of her disability. I noticed that many times, Rebecca struggled to fully participate in discussions and activities because people did not know how to communicate with her effectively. Despite her intelligence, talents, and willingness to contribute, communication barriers often left her excluded from conversations and decision-making processes. As I continued to support her, I realized that her experience was not unique. Many women with disabilities in our communities face similar challenges of exclusion, discrimination, and limited opportunities to participate in social and community life. Rebecca's resilience and determination inspired me to think about how more women with disabilities could be supported and included. Her story opened my eyes to the importance of creating a society where everyone, regardless of disability, is given the opportunity to be heard, valued, and involved. It is through helping Sister Rebecca and witnessing her daily struggles and strengths that the idea for the Empower Her Voice project was born. Our goal is to empower women with disabilities, raise awareness about
---	---

	inclusion, and encourage communities to create spaces where women like Rebecca can actively participate and thrive. 1 in 10 people in Ebonyi state live with some form of physical, sensory and intellectual disability. For women and youth, this reality creates a severe trap of financial dependence, social shame, and exclusion. In Nigeria, living with a disability is often treated as a limitation rather than a natural difference. In the farming and trading communities of Ikwo LGA, Ebonyi state these barriers are concrete. Most of the existing training centers do not accommodate adaptive needs, forcing families to carry disabled relatives as lifelong dependents. Social isolation happens quietly through omission, and despite widespread smartphone ownership, this population has been entirely left out of the digital commerce wave. To solve this, building a new, standalone disability center is unsustainable; it costs too much to run and reinforces segregation. creating a new website will not be sustainable. Team Ability Beyond Disability will be partnering will marketing platforms like Ebonyi Online Market place for them to market their crafts. Team Ability Beyond Disability layers practical solutions onto what already works. We are partnering with existing local centers to retrofit them for access rather than building from scratch. We teach digital entrepreneurship using simple, everyday tools like WhatsApp Business on smartphones people already own. Finally, we host public community exhibitions that dismantle stigma through visible proof of talent. This approach is low-cost, fast, and built to outlast the grant cycle.
--	--

Project Goal and Objectives <i>(What do you want your project to achieve; your goal should be S.M.A.R.T. Specific, measurable, Attainable, realistic, timebound)</i> <i>Hint: Improve out-of-school children's literacy rates, as well as their participation in society and access to opportunities.</i>	Within 4 weeks, equip 30 women, youth, and children with disabilities in Ikwo LGA, Ebonyi State, with adaptive vocational skills and basic digital entrepreneurship capability enabling at least 20 of them to begin generating income through local craft production and digital sales channels (social media/Ecommerce Platforms) by the end of the project period.
Objective <i>Empower out-of-school children by equipping them with the skills to read through literacy and capacity-building activities</i>	Train 30 women, youth, and children with disabilities in adaptive vocational skills which includes Soap-making, Crocheting, Bead Making, Millinery) through partnership with at least 2 existing local vocational centres in Ikwo LGA, within the first 2 weeks of the project. Onboard at least 25 of the 30 trained participants onto basic digital commerce tools like WhatsApp Business and/or Instagram and basic phone photography for product display, by the end of Week 3. Support at least 20 participants to list and actively market at least one product online, with a minimum of 10 participants recording at least one verified sale or customer inquiry by the end of Week 4. Host 1 community inclusion exhibition in Week 4, showcasing participant-made products to at least 100 community members, to publicly demonstrate the economic capability of persons with disabilities and shift local perception.

Project Activities <i>(What are the individual activities/steps you will carry out to implement your project and achieve your goal?) Ensure your Project goal aligns with the activities and outcomes</i> <i>Hint: Train local teachers and volunteers to teach out-of-school children how to read</i>	• Hold an orientation for the project team and volunteers on disability inclusion, basic sign language, and safeguarding to ensure all participants are treated with dignity and competence. • Meet with community leaders, ministry of women affairs, disability associations, and existing vocational training centres to secure partnerships and support. • Conduct door-to-door community visits to register 30 target beneficiaries, assess their adaptive needs, and group them by skill level. • Provide foundational training in self-confidence, self-advocacy, financial literacy, and basic business management.
	• Deliver practical vocational training in fields like soap-making, tailoring, or crafts by partnering with existing local centres. • Connect advanced participants to partner vocational centres for continued mentorship and long-term skill development. • Onboard participants onto WhatsApp Business and Instagram, and train them in basic smartphone photography to market their products. • Launch a community fundraising effort to mobilize materials, equipment, and local financial support from businesses and philanthropists. • Organize a public community exhibition and product fair where participants can display and sell their work directly to the public to reduce social stigma. • Evaluate project outcomes against targets, document success stories, and finalize a long-term referral and support plan with partner centres.

Expected Outcomes <i>(What improvement will you see in your target audience as a result of your project)</i> <i>Hint: 100 out-of-school children now have Improved literacy skills.</i>	• The project team and volunteers gain practical skills in disability dignity, safeguarding, and basic sign language. 30 • women and youth with disabilities complete foundational soft-skills training in self-confidence, financial literacy, and communication. • 30 participants successfully complete practical training in local trades like soap-making, tailoring, or crafts matched to their individual abilities. • At least 25 participants set up WhatsApp Business or Instagram accounts and learn to use phone photography to market their work online. • At least 20 participants launch independent income-generating activities or secure direct sales during the public exhibition. • Advanced participants are successfully linked with existing local vocational centres for
	ongoing training and mentorship after the project ends. • Local communities and leaders shift their perception of disability from a burden to capability through direct interaction and purchases at the public product fair.

Section Three: Defining Project Stakeholders

Partners <i>(They could be organisations who will support your project with financial or in-kind resources)</i>	• Ministry of Women Affairs • Ebonyi State Vocational College Abakaliki • National Directorate of Employment
--	--

Collaborators <i>(These are people that work with you on one or two activities in your project. e.g. the local teachers you are training in the community)</i>	• Tory's Crotchet will help in the training for the crocheting • Idinma's Handcraft will train them on Handcraft skills • SMJ beads will train them on beading making • Ekenyem Chioma will Assist with the Liquid Soap Making
Allies <i>(These are persons who are not involved in your project but take action to support your work, e.g. the community chairman who advocates for your project)</i>	• Nkwuda Rebecca is a Woman Living with Disability in my church • Dennis Nte is a leader is one of the disability centres in Abakaliki
Target audience <i>(persons benefiting from your project)</i>	Persons Living with Disability and residents at the training centres.

Section Four: Project Risk Assessment and Mitigation Strategies

S/N	Risk <i>(an uncertain event that may or may not happen during your project)</i> <i>Hint: Community leaders resist your project idea.</i>	Likelihood (Low, Medium, High) <i>Hint: High. Poor communication can increase the likelihood of this.</i>	Risk Impact (Low, Medium, High) <i>Hint: High This could mean your project might not take place in this community.</i>	Anticipated Mitigation Measures <i>(share how you intend to solve this)</i> <i>Hint: Engaging an impartial third party to facilitate a conversation between you and the community leaders.</i>
1	Communication barrier (hearing, speech, and visual impairment).	High	High. Low learning retention, participants drop	Use interpreters, learn sign language, and provide visual aids.
			out, and the training fails to build employable skills.	

2	Bad weather or environmental issues.	Medium	Medium. Repeated cancellations make the project seem unreliable and participants stop prioritising it.	Have an indoor backup venue and reschedule if necessary.
3	Lack of funds or resources.	Medium	High. This can lead to the termination of the project.	Raise funds through a fund drive, sponsorship, and support from experienced friends, plus donation of used apparatus from previous similar projects.
4	Health emergency during the event.	High. Persons with disabilities tend to have frequent medical emergencies.	High. It can disrupt the success of the project by interfering with the time needed to carry it out.	Keep first aid materials available and know nearby emergency contacts.
5	Stigma or discrimination from community members.	High. Persons with disabilities tend to feel isolated from their peers.	High. Isolation from community activities and ineffectiveness of the proposed project plan.	Educate the public beforehand and promote respect and inclusion.
6	Participants may refuse to attend or interact.	Medium	High. Participants' refusal can bring the project ideas to a standstill.	Explain the purpose clearly, build trust, and obtain informed consent before engagement and involve those our stakeholders who are already members of the community

Section Five: Project Schedule

S/N	Activity	Description	Responsible	Timeline
1	Stakeholders' engagement	Meeting and collaborating with Community leaders including the Igwe, individuals, organisations, and groups that can support the project.	Team Lead	Week 1, Day 1
2	Needs assessment	Distribute questionnaires, conduct interviews, focus group discussions, and observations to identify participants' interests, skills, barriers, preferred vocational skills, and accessibility needs.	Deputy Team Lead	Week1, Day 2
3	Learn sign language and Braille	Team members learn basic sign language and Braille to communicate effectively with deaf and visually impaired participants and promote inclusion.	Ifeoma Onyeka	Week 1, Day 3, and continues till the end of the project
4	Public engagement, fundraising and product raising	Create public awareness and mobilise money, vocational tools, books, assistive devices, raw materials, and equipment from individuals, businesses, alumni, NGOs, religious organisations, and philanthropists.	Ezeagwula Adaeze	Week 1, Day 4 – Day 7

5	Vocational school training	Provide practical training in selected marketable skills based on needs assessment, including soap making, bead making, crocheting, ICT, graphic design, or other relevant skills.	Team Lead	Week 2 Day 1 – Day 7
6	Social media campaign	Promote the project through social media platforms such	Ekwueme Richard	Week 2 Day 1 – Day7

		as WhatsApp Status, Instagram, Twitter, LinkedIn, and TikTok.		
7	Sign language and Braille learning continues	Team members continue practising sign language and Braille to strengthen communication with participants throughout the project.	Team Members	Week 2
8	Referring outstanding students to vocational centres	Connect exceptional participants with vocational institutions, apprenticeship programmes, employers, or advanced training centres for skill improvement and long-term development.	Deputy Team Lead	Week 3, Day 1 – Day 3
9	Publicity for exhibition fair	Create awareness before the exhibition to attract visitors, potential buyers, and stakeholders.	Ezeagwula Adaeze	Week 3 Day 1 – Day 7

10	Sign language and Braille learning continues	Team members continue improving their communication skills for better inclusion and participant support.	Team Members	Week 3
11	Exhibition fair	Participants display and sell products created during vocational training while visitors interact with participants, observe demonstrations, and learn about disability inclusion.	Mgbabor Ugochukwu and Ituma Virtuous	Week 4, Day 4
12	Monitoring evaluation and	Measure project achievements using indicators such as number of people trained, skills acquired, employment opportunities created, funds raised, and participant satisfaction.	Team Members	Week 4
13	Scalability planning	Plan how the project can continue, be sustained, and expanded beyond the initial implementation period.	Team Members	Week 4

Section Six: Project Budget

There are two sub-grant categories: the small (N200,000) and large (N400,000) subgrants. The subgrants will be disbursed in two tranches on the condition that your first implementation is successful (First tranche 70%, upfront and last tranche 30% upon the success of the first implementation phase).

S/N	Item/Activity	Cost	Cost Narrative (Reason behind the spend)

1	Transportation	N30,000	Transportation support for team members residing in Ikwo and Abakaliki during project mobilisation, training, and follow-up activities.
2	Vocational training facilitation	N110,000	Covers facilitation costs for crocheting (N20,000), bead making (N30,000), liquid soap making (N20,000), and video editing (N40,000).
3	Training materials and production items	N80,000	Purchase of plastics, chemicals, and bowls for liquid soap (N30,000); pins and wool for crocheting (N15,000); beads and fishing hooks for bead making (N20,000); and data for video editing practice (N15,000).
4	Registration to the Ebonyi Online Market for Marketing and Publicity	N15,000	Register the community so they can have easy access to the market and upload their goods only
5	Team branding and publicity materials	N60,000	Production of polo shirts for 7 team members and banners for programme visibility, identification, and community mobilisation.
6	Refreshment for attendees	N50,000	Light refreshments for participants and attendees during training sessions and the community exhibition.
7	Stipends to promising participants	N55,000	Small support stipends for selected promising participants to encourage continued practice and early-stage production after training.
	Total	N400,000	Total proposed budget aligns with the large sub-grant ceiling of N400,000.

Section Seven: Project Outcomes and Evaluation

S/N	Intended Outcome <i>Hint: Out-of-school children in Lokoma community can read without the support of teachers</i>	Success Indicator <i>Hint: 80 out-of-school children who could not read at the start of the project can now read successfully.</i>
1	Persons with disabilities participating in the project acquire practical adaptive vocational skills and become better prepared for income generation.	At least 30 participants complete the vocational training sessions in soap-making, crocheting, bead making, or millinery.
2	Participants improve their confidence, communication, and financial literacy for independent living and work.	At least 30 participants complete the foundational soft-skills and financial literacy training.
3	Participants gain basic digital commerce skills and can showcase and sell their products through online and offline channels.	At least 25 participants create and use WhatsApp Business, our Ecommerce platform, and/or Instagram accounts for business promotion, and at least 20 list and actively market at least one product online during the project period.
4	The project generates real economic engagement for beneficiaries.	At least 10 participants receive verified sales or customer inquiries before the end of the project.
5	Community perception of persons with disabilities begins to shift from pity and exclusion to capability and participation.	At least 100 community members attend the public exhibition and product fair, with visible engagement and purchases recorded.
6	The project creates a pathway for sustainability beyond the grant period.	At least 2 partner vocational centres agree to continue mentorship, referrals, or follow-up support after the project ends.
7	The project team and volunteers become more competent in disability inclusion and safeguarding	All project team members and volunteers complete orientation on disability dignity, basic sign language, and safeguarding before implementation begins.